First Congregational Church of St. Albans (FCC) is a welcoming community of spiritual seekers, believers, and doubters.

Please know that no *matter who you are or where you are on life's journey, you're welcome here.*

First Congregational Church Vision Statement

To create an open and loving community that encourages a joyous exploration with God.
To work together to care for and nurture the wider community.

First Congregational Church Mission Statement

Our mission as a community resource church is to provide a safe place for spiritual exploration and personal growth. To affirm the value of each person and to meet them where they are.
To connect to the community through personal service, giving, and pastoral care.

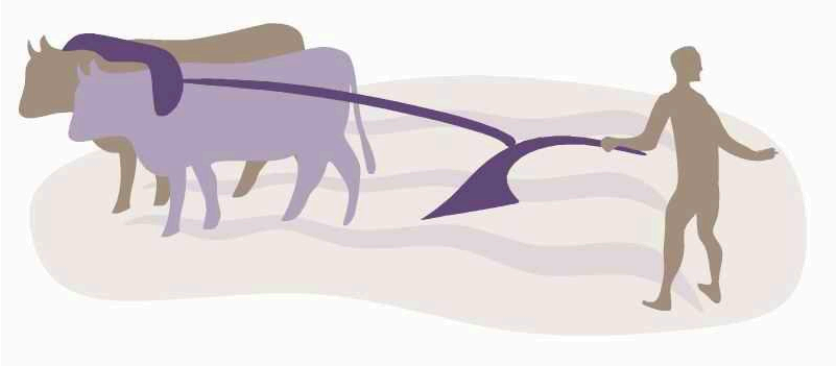
Please feel free to contact us:
Administrative Office: Tuesday - Friday: 9am- 2pm
Church Office Phone Number: 802-524-4555
Pastor Jessica's Office Hours:
Friday 9:30am-2:30pm and by Appointment
Email: pastorjessica@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
For urgent, pastoral matters outside of regular office hours, call Pastor Jessica at 207-632-5544.

Our worship service is broadcast over the local public access channel 1079 on Sundays at 4 PM.
Scripture Reader: Mara Vijups
Acolytes: Sophia Gagnon, Kaia Newton, Mykala Pryor, and Ada Sanders

UNITED CHURCH OF CHRIST

First Congregational Church of St. Albans

An open and affirming community.



"We welcome you and serve all through faith."

Worship with us:

June 29, 2025

10 A.M.

Rev. Jessica Moore, Pastor
Bailey Brown, Music and Choral Director
Stephan Conrady, Organist
Stephen McLaughlin, Office Manager
27 Church Street, St. Albans, VT 05478
802-524-4555

info@firstcongregationalstalbans.org
www.firstcongregationalstalbans.org

Third Sunday after Pentecost June 29, 2025

We Gather as God's People

Centering Words:
Sometimes the most scenic roads in life are the detours you didn't mean to take. — Angela N. Blount

❖ BEGINNING OF SERVICE ❖

THE PREPARATION

The beginning of the prelude is a call to enter into the spirit of prayer and community.

Prelude *America the Beautiful* S. Ward

Welcome and Announcement

Sung Call To Worship *Bless the Lord, My Soul* (Taizé)

Bless the Lord, my soul
and Bless God's Holy name
Bless the Lord, my soul
who leads me into life.

Morning Prayer[1] **(Unison)**

God who journeys with us, we gather together as we follow you. You have made rough ways smooth. You have parted seas. You have given us strength to climb mountains and courage to traverse valleys. We open ourselves to the heartbreak of caring for the world that you love. We claim hope and joy as our inheritance and portion. We remember that you are with us and give you thanks for the journey. Hallelujah and amen.

Welcome to all visitors: We are delighted that you chose to worship with us today and are strengthened by your participation in our service!
If you are new to First Congregational Church of St. Albans, please sign the guest book in the narthex (main entrance of the church).
If you would like more information about our church and its programs or would like to receive our Morning Reflections, and weekly e-newsletter, "From the Manse," please fill out a Welcome Card and place it in the Offering tray (be sure to include your email address).

After the service please join us for fellowship, conversation, coffee, and refreshments.

*Please Stand If You Are Able

[1]UCC Worship Ways

Music, Copyright permissions: CCLI #4799426 and SJMP #14586

Mission Highlight

The Welcome Home Initiative:
First Congregational Church of St. Albans is a founding member of the Welcome Home Initiative (WH). WH provides people transitioning from homelessness to permanent housing in Franklin and Grand Isle Counties of Vermont with new- home essentials (mop, broom, dishes, cleaners, trash can, pots & pans, etc.), personal items (shampoo, deodorant, etc.), and nonperishable food items.

The Welcome Home Initiative is a collaboration among:

- Franklin/Grand Isle CVOEO- Community Action
- First Congregational Church of St Albans
- Grace Episcopal Church, Sheldon
- St. Luke's Episcopal Church, St. Albans
- Sheldon Interfaith Food Shelf
- Holy Trinity Episcopal Church, Swanton
- Congregational Church of So. Hero
- St. Martins of Tours Inclusive Catholic Community
- Our local Girl Scout Troop

WH works with local housing case workers from:

- F/GI Community Action
- Voices Against Violence
- Samaritan House
- Restorative Justice Center
- Pathways
- Reach-Up
- Spectrum Youth and Family Services

First Congregational Church functions as the fiscal agent, collection center and pick-up hub for the program. WH serves on average 6-7 individuals/families to be housed a month.

HYMN*

O God Our Help In Ages Past (1,3,4) NCH 25

PRAYER OF TRANSFORMATION AND NEW LIFE[1] **(Unison)**

God of Grace, sometimes the call to follow you comes softly and gently. At other times, your call rushes in with urgency and may even overwhelm us as we balance the obligations of the day with the needs of the day. Gift us with discernment to know what needs our attention, focus, and energy. Free us of distractions, even and especially the ones we create for ourselves. At the same time remind us how to breathe and to be gracious toward one another. We travel a road we have not built and have not journeyed before. We rely upon you to demonstrate the way and lead us into the fullness of life and your kin-dom.

PAUSE FOR REFLECTION

WORDS OF ASSURANCE

PASSING OF THE PEACE

THE MESSAGE

SPECIAL MUSIC *Whatever Will Be* S. Conrady

SCRIPTURE READING Luke 9: 51-62

CONTEMPORARY READING:
Mother to Son Langston Hughes

MORNING REFLECTION *The Road Beyond Expectations*

HYMN* ***Let There Be Peace On Earth*** BB 35

THE THANKSGIVING

Sharing Our Joys and Concerns

Prayer of the People ~

Lord's Prayer

Our Father who art in heaven hallowed be thy name. Thy kingdom come thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread. And forgive us o ur trespasses, as we forgive those who trespass against us. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, and the power and the glory, forever, Amen

OFFERTORY

Doxology

Praise God from whom all blessing flow
Praise God all creatures here below;
Praise God above, all heavenly hosts:
Creator, Christ and Holy Ghost. Amen.

Offertory Prayer

THE DEPARTURE

Hymn*	***This Is My Song***	NCH 591
Benediction		
Postlude	*Star-Spangled Banner*	J. Smith

❖ END OF SERVICE ❖

Announcements:

A Special Note of Gratitude From All of Us At FCC:

- Melissa Beeman and Mara Vijups - Thank You for providing fresh, home grown, beautiful flowers for the altar! We are truly spoiled!
- Greg Beeman, Thank You for taking care of and covering the broken windows.

VOLUNTEERS NEEDED:
July 26
Church Street Festival: ice cream scoopers, tour guides, friendly faces, chit-chatters and more – we need you! Let's show FCC off to the community with all our love and humor !
See Paula or Sandy

SAVE THE DATE:
Sunday, July 20
3:30pm
Highgate Manor
La Bella Incgnita
Vivaldi * Purcell * Corelli
Donations accepted and will go to the "Raise the Floor" fund for St. John's Church in Highgate



Bible Study: On holiday for the summer.

Wifi:
Sanctuary
sanctuary123